

TIME RC - 2

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Read the following passages carefully and answer the questions that follow them.

Recently, a photograph of former British Prime Minister David Cameron went viral. He was seen carrying an empty carton, ostensibly helping in moving out of 10 Downing Street, the British PM's official residence. People all around the globe rightly hailed it as an indicator of simplicity and modesty, and an example of how grounded a VIP could be. Some on social media declared it to be the "coolest thing", going on to suggest that leaders worldwide must learn modesty from the gesture. It was later revealed that the photo was actually taken in 2007 when Cameron, who was then the opposition leader, and his family were moving into their new house in North Kensington, London. However, can it be denied that he was the leader of the opposition, who enjoys the status of a cabinet minister? Having settled that equivalence, we need to ask, how many of our own ministers could even be remotely seen carrying their own files, let alone their briefcases or boxes?

In India, can any one of our VIPs be ever seen carrying their own stuff? Forget the PM, the leader of opposition or any other minister, what about the young district magistrate or the superintendent of police? Is it an issue of mindset? If we have learnt so much from the British when they reigned in India, why did we not learn these commonplace things though we proclaim from rooftops about the dignity of human labour? I guess it is a mindset issue.

Incidentally, a narrative which is derived from the annals of history - maybe is factually incorrect - would have us believe that when the British forces laid siege to the kingdom of Bahadur Shah Zafar II in September 1857, he wanted to flee to Humayun's Tomb (where he took refuge and from where he was ultimately captured). However, his fleeing got delayed because, much to his chagrin, no servant was available to help the emperor put on his shoes! Maybe this is an exaggeration, as much of an incorrect depiction as that of the British PM carrying his own baggage. But the two exaggerations are pointers to the extremes of human behaviour.

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These illustrations bring us back to the oft repeated fact: when will we begin to take pride in our own actions and hence give up the VIP culture which seems to have settled so deep in our psyche? This attitude is causing us untold harm and is hurting our self-respect. This is the time when Gen Y or Gen Next must step in to take control and inculcate newer habits from their homes and in their progeny. Or else, it, will cost us dear, and prompt successful writers like Rama Bijapurkar to name their books We Are Like That Only.

As used in the passage, 'ostensibly' means all of the following EXCEPT:

☐ a) apparently

☐ b) seemingly

☐ c) obscurely (Correct Answer - ✓)

☒ d) evidently (Your answer - ✗)

According to the author, what is the mindset issue rampant in our country?

- ☐ a) The disinclination on the part of our ministers, district magistrates, etc. to be modest.
- ☐ b) The reluctance on the part of our ministers, district magistrates, etc. to carry their own files or briefcases.
- ☐ c) The hesitation of our ministers, district magistrates, etc. to bring in simplicity in their life.
- ☒ d) All of the above (Your answer - ✓)

Emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar's fleeing got delayed because, much to his chagrin, no servant was available to help the emperor put on his shoes. The author feels this could be:

- ☐ a) A hyperbole
- ☐ b) An overstatement
- ☒ c) Both A and B (Correct Answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) None of the above

The VIP culture which appears to be deep-rooted in our minds is causing untold harm. What does the author suggest?

- ☐ a) Gen Y or Gen Next to step in to take control of the situation and coax our politicians and senior bureaucrats into shedding their ego.
- ☒ b) To inculcate newer habits from our homes and in our offspring. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ c) To strike a balance between the conscious and subconscious mind which is responsible for reality testing and sense at personal identity.
- ☐ d) To train that part of the mind in which innate instinctive impulses and primary processes are manifest.

All of the following statements are true according to the passage EXCEPT

- ☐ a) A majority of politicians and bureaucrats in India don't believe in dignity of labour.
- ☐ b) To carry one's own stuff is beneath one's dignity is a fact deeply ingrained in the Indian psyche.
- ☒ c) The British were averse to dignity of labour during their reign in India. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) Most people in the world believe that VIPs should emulate David Cameron's modesty.

Directions for questions 6 to 10: Read the following passages carefully and answer the questions that follow them.

"I will not say, do not weep, for not all tears are an evil," says Gandalf, the iconic wizard in J.R.R. Tolkien's *The Lord of the Rings*. Kota Harinarayana had wept with joy on the day India's own Light Combat Aircraft flew for the first time in January 2001. He, along with A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, had worked day and night to develop the fighter. Fifteen years later, on 01 July 2016, the aircraft – christened Tejas by Prime Minister AtalBihari Vajpayee – got inducted into the Indian Air Force. Behind its success was a dedicated team of designers, engineers, technicians and test pilots who wanted to make India a warplane maker.

The shining aerial weapon of war joined the IAF more than three decades after the aeronautical engineer dreamed of it, and persuaded the Air Force and the defence ministry to go for the aircraft. It is a vastly improved replacement for the Russian aircraft, MiG-21, which has been the multirole workhorse of the Air Force, and could not be replaced by the heavier European Jaguars and Mirages, or by Russian Sukhois, which are dedicated bombers.

Tejas is the second fighter jet made in India. The first was Marut, designed and built by Hindustan Aeronautics Limited. As many as 147 of these aircraft joined the Air Force, but the plane named after the god of winds could not achieve the expected speed and power, as India could not get the high performing engines because of sanctions which followed the 1974 nuclear tests by Indira Gandhi. As the Air Force retired Marut in 1985, the dream of a new jet fighter was born.

Tejas, helmed by the Aeronautical Development Agency (ADA) of the defence ministry and built by HAL, has won its spurs with over 3,000 flights shattering the sound barrier over deserts, jungles, mountains and the picture-perfect countryside around Bengaluru, where it was born and took wing.

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LCA was both the pride and bane, as there were many hurdles to be cleared in design, assembly, material, engines, avionics and weapon systems, so much so that the Air Force despaired whether the flight will be airborne at all. There were even calls to abandon the "non-flying white elephant". But perseverance of ADA leaders like Kalam and Harinarayana made the metal bird fly for the first time on January 4, 2001. It has taken another 15 years for the first batch of two aircraft to be inducted into a resurrected squadron of the Air Force. It will take two more years for Tejas to be combat-ready. But ADA is already dreaming of designing and developing a bigger and powerful aircraft, which will suit the 21st century air defence and offence requirements.

Who is Kota Harinarayana, as you infer from the passage?

- ☐ a) An aircraft designer
- ☐ b) An aircraft technician
- ☐ c) A test pilot

☐ d) An ADA leader (Correct Answer - ✓)

The opening line of the second paragraph states, "The shining aerial weapon of war joined the IAF more than three decades after the aeronautical engineer dreamed of it." What prompted Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, the aeronautical engineer, to dream of it?

☐ a) The phasing out of MiG-21.

☒ b) The withdrawal of Marut aircraft. (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) The nuclear tests of May 1974, codenamed Smiling Buddha.

☐ d) The sarcastic remarks about Tejas that it's a "non-flying white elephant".

"Sanctions followed the 1974 nuclear tests by Indira Gandhi." In the event of a nuclear test by a country like ours, what are the sanctions generally imposed?

☐ a) Suspension of foreign assistance as humanitarian assistance, food, agricultural commodities, etc.

☐ b) Suspension of military sales.

☐ c) Suspension of credits and credit guarantees by government entities.

☒ d) All of the above (Correct Answer - ✓)

Which of the following is NOT TRUE according to the passage?

☐ a) MiG-21 has been the multirole workhorse of the IAF for decades.

☐ b) Marut was the first fighter jet made in India.

☒ c) Tejas has made more than 30,000 flights till date. (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ d) LCA had to clear many hurdles in design, assembly, material, engines, avionics and weapon systems.

Although Tejas has been inducted into the Air Force, the Aeronautical Development Agency is still dreaming of developing:

☐ a) an even lighter but powerful aircraft.

☒ b) a bigger and powerful aircraft. (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) a smaller and powerful aircraft.

☐ d) a bigger, aesthetically superior aircraft.

Directions for questions 11 to 15: Read the following passages carefully and answer the questions that follow them.

The maturing of Indian democracy with the slow but sure strengthening of representative institutions, the separation of powers, and increased participation in elections is a triumph for the people. But there are questions about the depth of our democratic consciousness. How much say do Indian citizens have in influencing important legislations that have a strong bearing on their lives? Is it merely enough for citizens to elect and thrust responsibility upon parliamentary representatives to make choices for them? Can there be other devices to supplement the functioning of Indian democracy to make it more accountable, participatory and deliberative?

As we ponder these questions, referendums – instruments of direct democracy where citizens get to directly vote on specific and important issues rather than for representatives who will make a choice on their behalf on those issues – have been in the news recently. The Brexit referendum, on whether Britain should stay in the European Union, concluded on June 23 with 52 per cent (of 72.2 per cent of the electorate that turned out) voting to “Leave”. The October 2 referendum called by the Colombian government to ratify the accord with the Revolutionary Armed Forces of Colombia (FARC) resulted in a “No” vote favoured by 50.3 per cent of the less than 38 per cent of the electorate that turned out.

In both these referendums, held in diverse regions, the outcome came as a surprise. Anger at perceived loss of jobs due to immigration saw many Britons (especially in England and Wales) voting for a Brexit. Post-vote analyses showed how this referendum was more of a protest vote aimed at the economic state of affairs in post-financial crisis Britain than a well-considered mandate for a new Britain that is out of the EU. Even the most ardent proponents of Brexit distanced themselves from their own autarkic positions in the run-up to the referendum after the vote. The complications of a Brexit seemed to have never been thought through by the proponents and Britain’s political class is still roiled about the manner and method of the impending Brexit.

In the case of Colombia, a painstaking series of negotiations between President Juan Manuel Santos’s government and the FARC, with external brokerage from Cuba, came to naught after the referendum failed to ratify the deal. Participation was low, and the defeat margin for those in favour of the deal was narrow. But the outcome put a major spanner in the implementation of a peace deal which was to bring closure to a half a century-old civil war that resulted in lakhs of deaths.

The opposition to the deal was driven by detractors who derided it for political rather than functional reasons. Former President Alvaro Uribe now suggests that the referendum was for a renewed peace deal that emphasizes greater accountability on FARC leaders for war crimes but this seems to be more of a feint to seek power during future negotiations.

According to the passage the most important question Indian democracy leaves is

- ☐ a) the intensity of our democratic consciousness.
- ☒ b) to what extent can the people of India influence the key legislations that have a strong bearing on their lives? (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ c) can we enhance involvement of people in elections?
- ☐ d) how can we empower representative institutions?

The passage speaks of instruments of direct democracy with examples. What is its implication with reference to Indian democracy?

- ☒ a) India should learn the results of the referendum held in Britain and Colombia. (Your answer - ✖)
- ☐ b) Instruments of direct democracy bolster the participatory process of Indian democracy. (Correct Answer - ✔)
- ☐ c) Referendums held in Britain and Colombia did not bring about justifiable results, therefore India should learn the meaninglessness of direct democracy.
- ☐ d) Devices of direct democracy do not beef up the participatory process of Indian democracy.

Solution:

Choice (A) tells that India should learn the results of referendum held in Britain and Colombia. It is a true statement but the passage doesn't contain such a direct statement. Moreover it doesn't explain how it is connected to Indian democracy. Refer to the fifth sentence of paragraph one. Therefore choice (A) is not correct. Choice (B) states that direct democracy bolsters the participatory process of Indian democracy. This can be inferred from para two of the passage. Therefore choice (B) is the correct answer. Choice (C) tells that India should learn the meaninglessness of direct democracy. Direct democracy has a meaningless side and meaningful side. This is an inference from the third and fourth paras. What is important is the meaningful side. Choice (C) is related to meaningless side and therefore choice (C) can be eliminated. Choice (D) states that instruments of direct democracy do not bolster the participatory process of Indian democracy. This is against the argument of the passage. Therefore choice (D) is not correct. The only correct answer is choice (B). Choice (B)

The outcome of the Brexit referendum is regarded

- ☒ a) as a protest vote pointed at the gloomy state of affairs of the British economy after the financial crisis. (Your answer - ✔)
- ☐ b) as a majority driven verdict by the people for a new Britain that is out of E.U.
- ☐ c) as an expression of resentment of the British at the estimated loss of jobs due to immigration.
- ☐ d) as a protest vote aimed at Prime Minister David Cameron.

According to the passage the Colombian referendum had many shortcomings and its aftermath was a set back because

- ☐ a) the long-suffering series of negotiations between the government and the FARC came to an end without any result.
- ☐ b) participation was low.
- ☐ c) the result put a stumbling block in the implementation of a peace deal that would have ended years of gory fighting.

☒ d) of the abrupt end of negotiations with FARC, low involvement of people and a stumbling block in the peace deal with FARC. (Your answer - ✓)

Which among the following possibilities is suggested by the president of Colombia?

- ☐ a) A renegotiated peace deal and greater responsibility for FARC leaders for war crimes
- ☐ b) A tricky move to seek political power prompted by referendum results
- ☐ c) An end to peace deal with FARC and restarting military action against the Colombian guerrillas

☒ d) Renegotiated peace deal with FARC leaders, greater responsibility for crime crimes and a tricky move to seize power from the side of FARC (Your answer - ✓)